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Correct Answer

Practice Exam - 1

Question 2 of 117



Which of the following valve prostheses should be replaced at the time of left ventricular assist device implantation

A. Bioprosthetic mitral valve

 B. Bioprosthetic aortic valve

C. Mechanical mitral valve

 D. Mechanical aortic valve

Commentary References

Answer: D. Mechanical aortic valve

The goal of the question is to highlight important surgical considerations regarding valvular pathology prior to/during LVAD implantation. Based on the guidelines, it is a Class I recommendation to replace a pre-existing aortic mechanical valve with a bioprosthetic valve (or oversewing the valve) at the time of LVAD implantation. Mechanical aortic valves that only intermittently open are prone to thrombosis which can increase stroke risk.

Answers A and B: In the systemically anticoagulated patient with bioprosthetic L-sided valves who is planned for implantation of continuous flow mechanical circulatory support there is no need to replace the valves at the time of surgery.

Answer C: With adequate anticoagulation, pre-existing mechanical mitral valves in LVAD patients have not been shown to

result in clinically significant thromboembolic events, as flow across the mitral valve continues to occur despite implantation of a ventricular assist device. Therefore, routine replacement of a mechanical mitral valve with a bioprosthesis is not recommended, but may be considered.

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